



AEROSPACE ENGINEER



JOB DESCRIPTION

Aerospace engineers design, build, and maintain a range of aircraft and spacecraft, from passenger airliners and military jets to satellites and space vehicles. In this role, you might work on the parts that make up the aircraft's fuselage, wings, or undercarriage, or the instruments and electronic systems that enable the pilot and crew to operate the craft.

SALARY

Junior aerospace engineer ★★☆☆☆

Senior aerospace engineer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Global opportunities • Diverse industry shaped by technological advances • Jobs in aircraft manufacturing firms, airline operators, armed forces, and government research agencies

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MECHANICAL ENGINEER** *see pp. 182–183*
- ▶ **ELECTRICAL ENGINEER** *see pp. 186–187*
- ▶ **DESIGN ENGINEER** Works in a range of industries, developing ideas for the design of new products and researching ways to improve existing ones.

The US aerospace and defense industry employs more than one million people across the country.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Aviation, aircraft, and flight technology • Mathematics • Physics • Information Technology (IT) • Engineering • Chemistry • Robotics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in aerospace engineering or similar, such as mechanical engineering or physics, is a minimum requirement.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are regular, but evening or weekend work may be necessary to meet project deadlines, or to deal with repairs and emergencies.



LOCATION Engineers usually carry out design work in an office, but may also visit aircraft hangars, production sites, or aeronautical laboratories.



THE REALITIES The job bears great responsibility as the work has a direct impact on the functioning of aircraft and the safety of passengers and crew.